

Germain Gauthier

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Department of Social and Political Sciences
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Research Interests

Fields: Political Economy, Public Economics

Topics: Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms, Social Media, Gender, Protests, Elections

Methods: Econometrics, Machine Learning, Deep Learning

Affiliations

CESifo Munich (*Economics of Digitization*)

IGIER & DONDENA (*AI and Society Initiative (DAISI), AXA Gender Lab*)

Positions

Assistant Professor of Economics, Bocconi University
Department of Social and Political Sciences

Sept. 2023 – present

Postdoctoral Researcher, ETH Zürich
Law, Economics, and Data Science Group

Mar. – Aug. 2023

Visitings

CESifo Munich

June 2026

Paris School of Economics
Department of Economics

Mar. – Apr. 2026

University of Lugano
Department of Economics

Jan. 2026

CESifo Munich

June 2024

ETH Zürich
Center for Data Science, Law and Economics

2020 / 2022

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique
Center for Research in Economics and Statistics (CREST)
Advisor: Alessandro Riboni

Sept. 2018– Aug. 2023

M.Sc. Analysis and Policy in Economics, Paris School of Economics	2017-2018
M.Sc. Quantitative Economics, HEC Paris	2013–2017
B.A. Philosophy, Université La Sorbonne	2013-2014

Publications

1. **The Political Effects of X's Feed Algorithm**, with Roland Hodler, Philine Widmer, and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya (2026) *Nature*. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-026-10098-2>
2. **Relatio: Text Semantics Capture Political and Economic Narratives**, with Elliott Ash and Philine Widmer (2023) *Political Analysis*, 32.1 (2024): 115-132.
3. **Les déterminants de la mobilisation des Gilets jaunes**, Boyer, P. C., Delemotte, T., Gauthier, G., Rollet, V., & Schmutz, B. (2020) *Revue économique*, 71(1), 109-138.

Working Papers

4. **Artificial Inequality: Large Language Models Disadvantage Women Job Seekers**
(with Kenza Ellass, Debora Nozza, and Paola Profeta)
Revise and resubmit at Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences
5. **Cycling through Elections: The Political Consequences of the Tour de France**
(with Ala Alrababah, Maelle Delouis-Jost, and Adam Polak)
Revise and resubmit at American Political Science Review
6. **Measuring Crime Reporting and Incidence: Method & Application to #MeToo**
7. **The Lifecycle of Protests in the Digital Age**
(with Pierre Boyer, Yves Le Yaouanq, Vincent Rollet, and Benoît Schmutz)

Work in Progress

8. **Deep Latent Factor Models for the Social Sciences**
(with Philine Widmer and Elliott Ash)
9. **The Neural Ideal Point Model**
(with Hugo Subtil and Philine Widmer)
10. **Do politicians put their votes where their mouths are?**
(with Caroline Le Pennec and Vincent Pons)
11. **On Differences in Social Media Consumption**
(with Roland Hodler, Katharina Kaepfel, Alberto Ornaghi, and Philine Widmer)

Software

1. **deeplatent** – A Python package to estimate deep latent factor models.
2. **relatio** – A Python package to extract narrative statements from texts.

Teaching

Lectures

Text as Data for the Social Sciences (with Philine Widmer), USI Lugano	2026
Diversity and Global Policy, Bocconi	2023 – present
Undergraduate Public Finance, Bocconi	2023 – present
Text as Data for the Social Sciences (with Philine Widmer), LMU München	2022, 2023
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Paris	2022
Co-organizer of the event with Etienne Ollion (PI) and Félix Lennert	
Lectures on “Text as Data for the Social Sciences.”	
Introduction to Working with Stata, M.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2020

Teaching Assistance

Econometrics, M.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2019
Econometrics, M.Sc. ENSAE	2018
Introduction to Economics, B.Sc. Ecole Polytechnique	2018, 2019
Macroeconomics, B.Sc. ENSAE	2018

Professional Service

- Co-organizer of the *DONDENA AI and Society Initiative (DAISI)*
- Member of the scientific committee for the *Monitoring Democracy (MoDe)* quarterly survey
- Member of the *Equal Opportunities Committee* at Bocconi
- Referee for *The American Economic Review*, *The Journal of Political Economy*, *The American Journal of Political Science*, *The Journal of Politics*, *The Economic Journal*, *Political Analysis*, *Journal of Population Economics*, *The European Journal of Political Economy*, *Social Science Research*, *Democratization*, *Nature Scientific Data*, *Economia Italiana*
- Referee for the book *Machine Learning for Econometrics* (by Jeremy L’Hour and Christophe Gaillac)
- Replication analyst for *Economic Policy* (2022/2023)

Grants & Awards

IGIER Junior Researchers’ Grants (PI, 10K€)	2026
Bocconi Junior Researchers’ Grants (PI, 10K€)	2026
Project: On Differences in Social Media Consumption	
Bocconi Innovation in Teaching Award	2024
Swiss National Sciences Foundation (SNSF) Grant (300K CHF)	2023–2026
Team member (PI: Roland Hodler)	
Project: Political Polarization and Algorithms	
Swiss National Sciences Foundation (SNSF) Grant (100K CHF)	2020

Team member (PI: Elliott Ash)

Project: Mining Narratives From Large Text Corpora

Laboratoire d'Excellence Ph.D. Grant

2018–2023

Project: Essays in Political Economy

Policy Briefs and Media Columns

1. Dazi, l'83% degli italiani teme una possibile guerra commerciale, *Corriere della sera*, July 2025
2. The Impact of #MeToo on Sex Crimes, April 2024
3. Vers une hybridation des mouvements sociaux et des réseaux sociaux ? L'exemple des "Gilets jaunes", *Blog IPP*, juillet 2020, with Thomas Delemotte, Germain Gauthier, Vincent Rollet et Benoît Schmutz.
4. Le territoire des gilets jaunes, *Note IPP* n° 39, Avril 2019, with Pierre Boyer, Thomas Delemotte, Vincent Rollet & Benoit Schmutz
5. Entre Facebook et le rond-point, "la double originalité du mouvement des gilets jaunes", *Le Monde*, Novembre 2019, with Pierre Boyer, Thomas Delemotte, Vincent Rollet & Benoit Schmutz
6. Fiscal consolidation episodes in OECD countries: the role of tax compliance and fiscal space, *Bulletin de la Banque de France*, no. 45, Spring 2017, with Francesco Pappadà & Laurent Ferrara.

Conferences and Presentations

USI Lugano, Paris School of Economics, Office of Communications (Ofcom), APSA	2026
University of Milan, Collegio Carlo Alberto, Université Paris-Dauphine, Polmeth Europe, Comptext, URPP Conference on Gender Issues in Education and the Labor Market, "CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society", Venice Summer Institute Workshop on Digital Platforms, SPS Conference, Summer Institute on Computational Social Sciences (SICSS) at Lake Como	2025
Winter School in Behavioral Economics and Experimental Research, Bocconi, ETH Zürich, ENS Lyon Advanced Methods Workshop, SPS Conference	2024
HEC Lausanne, Bocconi, University of Warwick, LMU München, Sciences Po, Erasmus University, University of St. Gallen, Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy	2023
Webinaire Economie Politique Francophone, University of St. Gallen, SICSS Paris, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime, ETH Zürich, University of Zürich, CREST	2022
ETH Zürich, Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics, Polmeth Europe, Polmeth US, Monash-Warwick-Zurich Conference, CREST	2021
Comptext, Université Paris-Nanterre, Paris School of Economics	2020
SICSS Zürich, Monash-Warwick-Zurich Conference, CREST	2019

Languages

French, English, German, Python, R, Stata

References

Alessandro Riboni

Ecole Polytechnique

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Xavier d'Haultfoeuille

ENSAE

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Ekaterina Zhuravskaya

Paris School of Economics

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Elliott Ash

ETH Zürich

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